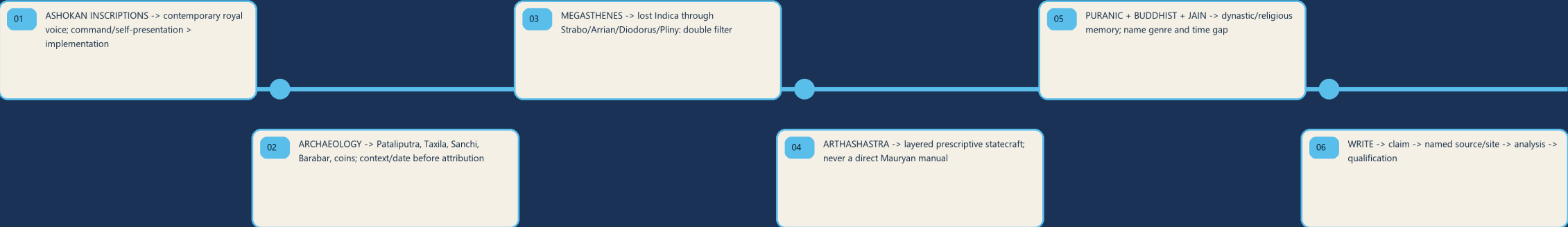


THE MAURYAN EMPIRE

Power • communication • differentiated control • Ashokan dhamma

CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER

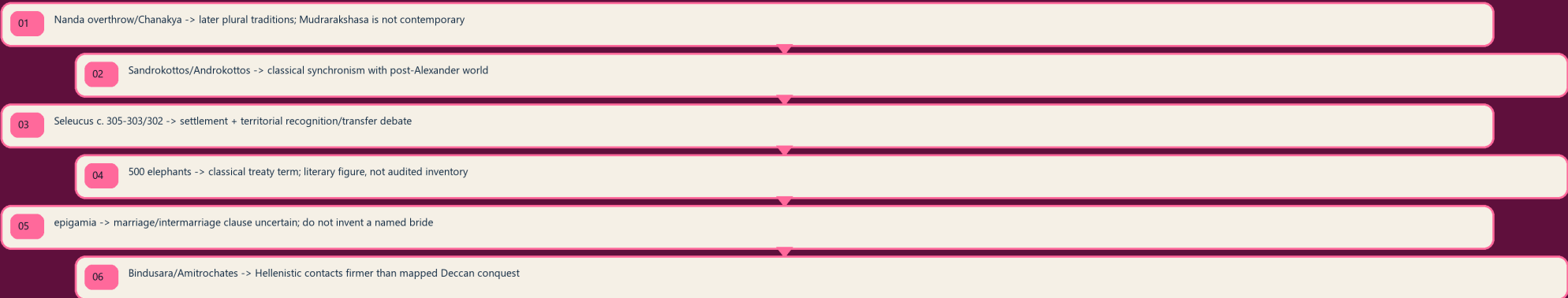
1 SOURCE FIREWALL



2 RISE, RULERS AND CHRONOLOGY

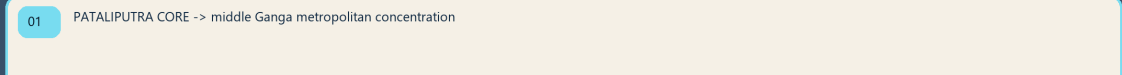


3 CHANDRAGUPTA, SELEUCUS AND BINDUSARA

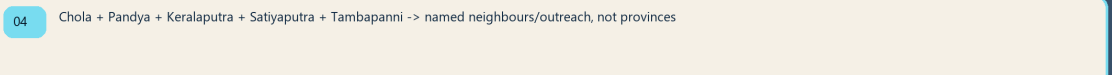


4 IMPERIAL GEOGRAPHY: RULE, INFLUENCE AND ABSENCE

CAPACITY / CORE



VARIATION / LIMIT



4

IMPERIAL GEOGRAPHY: RULE, INFLUENCE AND ABSENCE

CAPACITY / CORE

01

PATALIPUTRA CORE -> middle Ganga metropolitan concentration

02

NW -> Taxila, Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Kandahar: multilingual frontier/corridor

03

WEST -> Ujjayini/Girnar; EAST -> Tosali, Dhauli, Jaugada; SOUTH -> Suvarnagiri/edict belt

VARIATION / LIMIT

04

Chola + Pandya + Keralaputra + Satiyaputra + Tambapanni -> named neighbours/outreach, not provinces

05

far south and much north-east lack proof of direct Mauryan rule; absence != empty land

06

FIND-SPOT -> communication/contact; never draw a modern border around edicts

5

KINGSHIP, PROVINCES AND LOCAL MEDIATION

01

KING -> appointment + army + justice + patronage + command, dependent on information

02

mantriparishad/ministers -> textual reconstruction; inscriptions reveal only parts

03

kumara/aryaputra + provincial centres -> dynastic delegation, not one universal template

04

province -> district/field -> town/village -> households, guilds, local elites

05

Taxila/Ujjayini/Tosali/Suvarnagiri -> cautious node list, not exhaustive schedule

06

central purpose + regional adaptation + intermediary information gaps

6

OFFICERS AND INSCRIPTIONAL FUNCTIONS

1.

mahamatta -> broad high-official category; specialised portfolios, not one rank

2.

dhamma-mahamatta -> Major Rock Edict V: social/religious/welfare policy, not clergy

3.

pradeshika + rajuka + yukta -> Rock Edict III tours; official 2025 key = district level

4.

rajuka -> populations, justice/welfare; land-measurement link remains suggestive

5.

yukta -> executive/accounting/subordinate contexts; exact hierarchy debated

6.

Rock Edict VI pativedaka reporting -> accessibility ideal + imperial information strategy

7

ARMY, ESPIONAGE AND JUSTICE

01

fiscal base -> infantry + cavalry + chariots + elephants + forts/corridors

02

Megasthenes military/city committees -> later fragments; useful, not audited universal chart

03

Arthashastra spies/secret agents -> theory of surveillance; corroborate before application

04

Pillar Edict IV -> rajuka responsibility + uniformity concern + three-day reprieve

05

death penalty, punishment and forest warning continue after Kalinga

06

VERDICT -> coercive state constrained by paternal justice, not abolished by dhamma

8

REVENUE, LAND, IRRIGATION AND EXCHANGE

8

REVENUE, LAND, IRRIGATION AND EXCHANGE

01

agriculture/land/labour -> bhaga + bali + tolls + fines + obligations -> treasury/army/officials

02

Rummindei -> local bali exemption + bhaga reduced to one-eighth; not empire-wide rate

03

Sudarshana -> later Junagadh record: Pushyagupta/Chandragupta + Tushaspha/Ashoka

04

roads/rivers/security/standards -> facilitate and tax trade

05

punch-marked coins -> circulation; issuer/date/state monopoly uncertain; kind/barter persist

06

Arthashastra mines/forests/workshops -> strategic regulation model, not command economy fact

9

SOCIETY, DEPENDENCE AND WOMEN

01

Megasthenes seven groups -> Greek occupation/status scheme, not varna-jati census

02

Brahmana/Kshatriya prestige + cultivators/merchants/artisans/soldiers/officials -> varied positions

03

dasa/dasi + bhataka + debt/service -> dependence; translation and prevalence uncertain

04

2022 Arthashastra PYQ -> answer textual provision first, then prescription/practice caution

05

Queen Karuvaki -> named elite gift agency; cannot generalise equality

06

urban-rural flows + patriarchal household + regional/forest difference remain

10

ASHOKA, KALINGA AND RETAINED SOVEREIGNTY

CAPACITY / CORE

01

later succession/fratricide stories -> moral biography, not contemporary fact

02

Minor Rock Edict I -> gradual Buddhist commitment before simple Kalinga-conversion story

03

Major Rock Edict XIII -> conquest + deportation/death/suffering claims + remorse

VARIATION / LIMIT

04

Separate Kalinga Edicts -> fairer administration, restraint, confidence-building

05

dhamma-vijaya preferred -> ethical reorientation of victorious kingship

06

Kalinga retained + army/punishment/atavika warning -> no full pacifism

11

DHAMMA, WELFARE AND TOLERATION

01

CONTENT -> parents/elders + servants + Brahmanas/Shramanas + truth + restraint + non-injury

02

Rock Edict XII -> restrain self-praise/denunciation; listen and grow essentials of all sects

03

MACHINERY -> dhamma-mahamattas + tours + reports + oral recitation + inscriptions

04

Rock Edict II -> medical/useful plants/wells horizon for humans and animals

05

animal policy -> reduction/restriction with exceptions; not total meat/hunting ban

06

dhamma = Buddhist-rooted public ethic + paternal integration; not state conversion/modern welfare state

- 04

Rock Edict II -> medical/useful plants/wells horizon for humans and animals
- 05

animal policy -> reduction/restriction with exceptions; not total meat/hunting ban
- 06

dhamma = Buddhist-rooted public ethic + paternal integration; not state conversion/modern welfare state

12

EDICT CLASSES, SCRIPTS, LANGUAGES AND SITE TRAPS

1.

MINOR ROCK -> personal zeal/name evidence; MAJOR ROCK -> broad policy; PILLAR -> mature governance

2.

SEPARATE KALINGA -> Dhauli/Jaugada; local sequence/omission matters

3.

most -> Prakrit-Brahmi; Shahbazgarhi/Mansehra -> Prakrit-Kharoshthi

4.

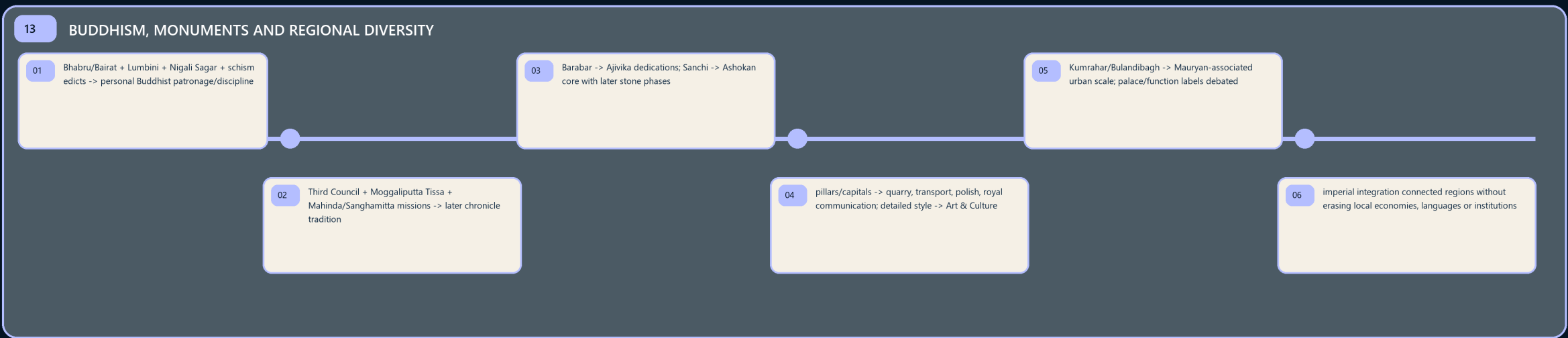
Kandahar/north-west -> Greek and Aramaic adaptation, not one literal master translation

5.

Maski/Gujarra -> Ashoka name; Rummindei/Nigali Sagar -> Terai pilgrimage records

6.

TRAP -> site + corpus + script + theme + audience; no site contains a complete universal set



14

HISTORIOGRAPHY, ANSWER ROUTE AND DECLINE BRIDGE

01

CENTRALISED MODEL -> court + revenue + army + officers + edicts + strategic works

02

DIFFERENTIATED MODEL -> distance + ecology + local mediation + multilingual variants + uneven archaeology

03

SYNTHESIS -> strong metropolitan/corridor capacity; graded direct rule, tribute and negotiated frontiers

04

governance = information + mobility + extraction + legitimacy; communication also reveals limits

05

post-Ashoka names vary; Dasharatha cave inscriptions are firmer than full succession lists

06

ANSWER -> define/source matrix -> rulers/map -> institutions/economy -> Ashoka/dhamma -> debate -> qualified verdict

ANSWER SPINE

source matrix → rulers/map → institutions/economy → Ashoka/dhamma → debate → qualified verdict

Never equate edict reach with uniform rule, dhamma with conversion, or Arthashastra with an implemented manual.